

Welcome to Study Hall (at home) - Guide Handbook

This guide is for you - Guide applicants and Guides joining the Study Hall team.

You're about to step into a role that is rare: meaningful work with students, on a schedule you control, with room to do your own quiet work during the hour - and you get paid for showing up well.

Please read this fully before your first live Study Hall. It explains what the job is, how to run a great hour, how we stay safe, and what "done right" looks like. The standards are clear so you can succeed with confidence - not so we can trip you up.

Why this role is a great fit

Most online education jobs ask you to tutor, teach a curriculum, or perform on camera the whole time. Study Hall is different.

As a Guide, you run a **private, live, one-hour Study Hall** for **one student**. Your job is structure and accountability: help them start, stay focused, and get their own work done. You are **not** expected to tutor or do their homework.

That design is intentional - and it's part of what makes the role sustainable:

- **You choose when you work.** Set availability that fits your life. Take Study Halls when you want them.
- **The hour is calm by design.** Students are supposed to be working. You check in, redirect when needed, and keep the container strong - you are not running a nonstop lecture.
- **Between check-ins, you may do your own quiet work** on your side of the call (reading, studying, light laptop work) as long as you stay on camera, stay reachable, and stay actually present for the student. This is not a babysitting black hole and not a second full-time performance job.
- **You earn for real sessions you fulfill well** - join on time, run the hour properly, submit the report. Reliable Guides who treat families well get more opportunities.

We're excited you're here. Families trust us with an important hour of their child's evening. If you take that seriously *and* like the flexibility of this model, you're exactly who we want on the team.

1. What Study Hall is

Study Hall (at home) is a **private, live, one-hour video session** between **one student** and **one Guide**.

Parents book Study Hall so homework time stops being a fight. Your job is to make that hour real: the student sits down, starts, stays on task, and finishes what they can.

After every session, the parent gets a **short report** and a **recording** in their Parent Portal.

What you are

- A calm, professional presence for the hour
- A structure and accountability partner
- Someone who redirects focus and protects the routine
- Someone who starts on time, stays on camera, and closes the loop with the report

What you are not

- A tutor, teacher, or homework-doer
- Someone who teaches new curriculum or "explains the whole chapter"
- A babysitter who lets the student scroll or half-work for an hour
- A friend hanging out on video
- A therapist, household disciplinarian, or substitute parent

If a parent or student asks you to tutor:

"Study Hall Guides provide structure and accountability - not tutoring. I can help you stay on track with the work you already have."

Don't invent policy. Escalate product or account questions to Study Hall support.

2. The opportunity (how the work feels day to day)

A well-run Study Hall has a rhythm:

1. **Open strong** (a few minutes) - greet, confirm cameras, name tonight's work plan
2. **Work block** - student works; you monitor and check in; you may quietly do your own light work between check-ins
3. **Redirect when needed** - phone, tabs, stalling, "I don't feel like it"
4. **Close clean** - what got done, what's left, goodbye
5. **Report** - short parent update while it's fresh, then you're done

You're not paid to ignore the student. You *are* set up to earn without burning out - presence and professionalism first, with space in the hour that tutoring jobs never give you.

Think of it as: **you're the grown-up in the room who makes the hour count** - not the entertainer, not the teacher of record.

3. How to conduct a Study Hall

3.1 Before the session (T-15 to T-5)

- Be logged into the Guide portal early enough that you're not rushing
- Double-check the session time in your local timezone
- Join when the door opens (**typically 5 minutes before start**). Don't wait until the exact start minute
- Quiet, well-lit space; stable internet; device charged or plugged in
- Headphones help; silence personal notifications that would interrupt you mid-redirect
- Mindset: their work list is the point of the hour; your own quiet tasks are secondary and only between check-ins

If you can't make a session, follow Study Hall's unavailability / coverage process **as early as possible**. No-shows and last-minute ghosts break trust - with families and with the team.

3.2 Opening (first 3-5 minutes)

1. Greet the student by name - warm, calm, professional
2. Confirm camera and mic work both ways
3. Ask: **What are you working on tonight?** Get a concrete list
4. Help them **order** the hour (due-soon / hardest first is usually right - suggest, don't dictate household homework rules)
5. Set the norm: "I'll check in every so often. Camera stays on. You do the work; I'm here to keep us on track."
6. If they have nothing assigned: guide them to review, reading, organizing notes, or studying for a named class - still a working hour, not a hangout

Don't burn the opening on small talk about your day or school drama.

3.3 During the hour (the work block)

Default posture: student works; you observe, encourage, and redirect. Between check-ins, quiet personal work on your side is fine if it never costs the student your attention when they need it.

Good check-ins

- "What are you on now?"
- "Phone face-down / close that tab - we're on science until :40."
- "Take sixty seconds, then we're back."
- "Show me you're on the worksheet." (visual accountability - not doing it for them)
- "You're deep in this - keep going; I'll check back in a few minutes."

Light help that's allowed (still not tutoring)

- Finding the assignment, login, or instructions they already have
- Breaking a big task into steps

- Pointing them back to *their* notes, textbook, or teacher resources
- Timeboxing ("Ten more on math, then we switch")

Not allowed

- Solving problems for them
- Rewriting essays
- Teaching new concepts as their teacher
- Using AI (or your own work) to produce answers they turn in as theirs
- Doing the project while they watch

If they ask you to tutor

"I can't tutor in Study Hall - that's not what this hour is for. I *can* help you stay on it. What's the first step you can try?"

If they're stuck on content

Send them to their materials or "mark it and ask your teacher tomorrow," then move to other work they *can* do.

Presence rules while doing your own quiet work

- Camera stays on
- You notice when they go idle, off-task, or off-camera - and you intervene
- No headphones-in-another-world energy; no second job that needs calls or talking
- No driving, cooking a full meal, or leaving the frame
- If you can't honestly say you'd notice a problem within a minute or two, you're too checked out - close the laptop tab and re-engage

3.4 Breaks

Short stretch/water breaks (1-2 minutes) are fine. Don't turn the hour into a hangout. Don't disappear from the frame for long stretches.

3.5 Closing (last 3-5 minutes)

1. Stop new work with enough time to close properly
2. Have them say what they finished and what's left
3. Affirm real effort - no fake praise
4. End on time through the product exit flow (default: don't casually run long)

3.6 After the session (required)

Submit the **post-session report right away** while details are fresh. Parents rely on it. Proper close-out is part of how sessions are fulfilled and how you get paid for completed work - don't skip it.

Keep reports factual, kind, and specific:

- Subjects / tasks worked on

- Focus and effort
- Finished vs remaining
- Issues if any (late join, tech, off-camera, refusal to work) - honest, not harsh

No diagnoses, insults, or gossip in reports.

4. Fulfillment requirements (how you get paid for real)

These are the job - clear so you always know what "good" is.

Requirement	Standard
On-time presence	Ready by session start; preferably in at door-open (T-5)
Camera on	Your camera on for the Study Hall; hold the student to product camera rules
Actually present	Reachable and attentive enough to redirect - not AFK, not driving, not on another call
One-on-one integrity	No extra people on your side; don't re-record onto personal devices
No tutoring / no doing the work	Structure and accountability only
Professional setting	Quiet, appropriate background
Recording	Product recording supports quality and safety - don't obstruct it; don't promise deletions
Report submitted	Every completed Study Hall gets a timely, accurate in-product report
Honesty	Never mark a session successful if it didn't meaningfully happen
Policy compliance	Follow safety, privacy, and communication rules below

Do these consistently and you build a reputation as a Guide families (and we) can trust - which is how you get more of the flexible hours you want. Serious violations can mean coaching, loss of schedule access, or removal from the team.

5. Dress code

You're on camera with a student in a product parents trust. Look like someone they'd be glad to leave their child with for an hour.

Yes

- Clean, neat appearance
- Opaque, non-revealing top; no offensive graphics or slogans
- Presentable for whatever the camera shows (assume upper body is in frame)

No

- Pajamas, revealing clothing, swimwear
- Hate, sexual, drug, or violent imagery on clothes
- Campaign merch or anything that makes the hour about your politics
- Hats that hide your face; sunglasses indoors
- Costumes or "bit" outfits

Environment

- Tidy, neutral background (or subtle blur if the product supports it)
- Face clearly lit - avoid strong backlight
- No alcohol, tobacco, or drug paraphernalia in frame
- Avoid looking like you joined from bed if you can help it

If something inappropriate appears mid-session, fix it immediately or end and escalate.

6. Communication code

With students

- Warm, clear, firm when needed - never mocking, flirtatious, or demeaning
- School-appropriate language
- No sexual topics; no discussing dating lives (yours or theirs)
- No politics/religion arguments or culture-war debates
- **Never** share personal contact info (phone, WhatsApp, Discord, Instagram, email, etc.)
- **Never** move the conversation off Study Hall
- **Never** meet students outside the product

With parents

- Only through **approved Study Hall channels**
- Don't collect parent numbers for private side chats
- The report is the main post-session update
- Don't argue; don't promise grade outcomes or tutoring results
- If a parent is upset: stay calm, document what's needed, escalate to support

Tone examples

Good: "Let's put the phone away and finish the science worksheet. What's question four asking?"

Bad: "Just ChatGPT it - I won't tell your mom."

Good: "I can't do the problems for you, but try the first one while I watch you work."

Bad: You screenshare and solve the assignment for them.

Privacy

- Don't screenshot, download, or post student work, faces, reports, or recordings
- Don't talk about specific families on social media or with friends
- Treat everything you see in session as confidential

7. Safety standards

You may be alone on video with a minor. When in doubt, protect the student and protect yourself - then tell Study Hall.

Always

- Stay in the Study Hall product session; keep the recording path intact
- Keep your camera on; keep interactions appropriate and observable
- End the session and escalate if you feel unsafe or the student's environment looks unsafe

Escalate immediately if you observe or hear

- Abuse, neglect, self-harm, or that the student may be in danger
- Sexual talk, sexual imagery, or anything that sexualizes the Guide-student relationship
- Pressure to move off-platform
- An adult on their side behaving threateningly or inappropriately
- A clearly unsafe situation you can't normalize

If someone is in immediate physical danger: contact **local emergency services** first, then notify Study Hall through the official support / safety path.

Write down what you saw or heard factually (time, words, what you did). Use the escalation channel for detail; keep parent-facing report notes high-level and appropriate.

Never

- "Secrets from your parents" about concerning topics
- Asking a student to hide the session
- Continuing a session that has become inappropriate - end it and report

Session / tech honesty

- If A/V fails and you can't restore a usable session, don't pretend the hour happened
- If the student never appears, follow product no-show / wait rules, document, close out honestly
- If you disconnect for an emergency, rejoin if you can and report what happened

8. Reliability - how you keep the flexible schedule privilege

Flexibility works when Guides are dependable.

- Honor the availability you set
- Repeated cancellations, late joins, or no-shows put your schedule access at risk
- Never share your Guide login or hand a session to someone else
- Don't run other gigs that need your voice/attention during the hour
- Pay and earnings questions go through official Study Hall Guide channels - never side deals with parents

Show up well -> keep earning on your terms. That's the deal.

9. Before your first live family (clear-to-live)

We're glad you applied. Before you take real parent sessions, you should be able to:

1. Explain the role correctly (structure vs tutoring) - including that quiet personal work between check-ins is allowed only with real presence
2. Run a clean mock: open -> work block -> close
3. Meet dress / setting standards on camera
4. Handle "can you just do this for me?" the right way
5. Join, exit, and submit the report in-product
6. Know what to escalate vs handle in-session

When you've got those down, you can be **cleared for live Study Halls** - and start earning with us.

10. Pin this

Do: On time · Camera on · Student works · Check in and redirect · Quiet own work only between real check-ins · Short factual report · Escalate safety

Don't: Tutor · Do the homework · Go off-platform · Flirt / overshare · Skip the report · Fake a session · Fully check out

Your one-liner

"I'm your Study Hall Guide - I keep the hour focused while you do your own work."

Welcome to the team. Take the standards seriously, enjoy the flexibility, and run hours families can trust. That's how Study Hall works - and how you build a great book of sessions on your schedule.

- *Study Hall (at home), Guide Operations*